

Please check the examination details below before entering your candidate information

Candidate surname	Other names
Centre Number	Candidate Number

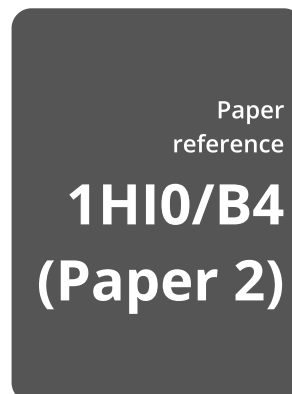
Pearson Edexcel GCSE (9-1)

Thursday 4 June 2026

Morning (Time: 1 hour 50 minutes -
total time for **both** booklets)

History

**BOOKLET B4: Early Elizabethan England,
1558-88**



You must have:

The corresponding booklet P.

Total Marks

Instructions

- Use **black** ink or ball-point pen.
- **Fill in the boxes** at the top of this page with your name, centre number and candidate number.
- There are two booklets in this question paper. **This is booklet B.**
- Answer questions 1(a), 1(b), 2 and **either 3 or 4** in this booklet.
- Check you have the corresponding booklet P.
- Answer the questions in the spaces provided
- *there may be more space than you need.*

Information

- The total mark for this booklet is 32.

- The total time for **both** booklets is 1 hour 50 minutes.
- The marks for **each** question are shown in brackets
- use this as a guide as to how much time to spend on each question.
- **Do not forget to complete booklet P.**

Advice

- Read each question carefully before you start to answer it.
- Try to divide your time equally between each booklet of the question paper.
- Check your answers if you have time at the end.

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Early Elizabethan England, 1558-88

Answer Question 1(a), Question 1(b), Question 2 and EITHER Question 3 OR Question 4.

1 (a) Describe one feature of Elizabethan grammar schools. (2)

(b) Describe one feature of Elizabethan pastimes for the rich. (2)

(Total for Question 1 = 4 marks)

- 2 Explain why the Babington Plot (1586) led to the execution of Mary, Queen of Scots. (12)

You **may** use the following in your answer:

- Walsingham's spies
- The Act for the Preservation of the Queen's Safety

*You **must** also use information of your own.*

Turn over ►

(Total for Question 2 = 12 marks)
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Answer EITHER Question 3 OR Question 4.

EITHER

- 3** "The religious settlement of 1559 successfully solved the problem of religion in England."

How far do you agree? Explain your answer.

*You **may** use the following in your answer:*

- Catholic recusancy
- Puritan opposition

*You **must** also use information of your own.*

(Total for Question 3 = 16 marks)

OR

- 4** "Elizabeth's government was completely dependent on the Privy Council."

How far do you agree? Explain your answer.

*You **may** use the following in your answer:*

- William Cecil
- Parliament

*You **must** also use information of your own.*

(Total for Question 4 = 16 marks)

Chosen question number: Question 3 ☐ Question 4 ☐

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This image shows a full page of a document template designed for handwritten notes or essays. It features approximately 30 evenly spaced, thin grey horizontal lines extending across the entire width of the page. The background is plain white, providing a clear space for writing. There are no margins, headers, footers, or other graphical elements present.

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TOTAL FOR BOOKLET B = 32 MARKS

PLEASE ENSURE YOU ALSO COMPLETE BOOKLET P.

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